Winter option 4

What we are eating

- **Lunch, Mon to Wed:** Spicy peanut tofu bowls
- **Lunch, Thu and Fri (and Wednesday's dinner):** Teriyaki tofu bowls
- **Dinner, Mon and Tue:** Tofu stir fry
- **Dinner, Thu and Fri:** Vegetarian bibimbap
- **Breakfast:** Egg muffins **Snack:** Granola bars
- **His meat, cooked separately:** Chicken teriyaki, added to his lunches and to Wednesday's dinner. Everything else is vegetarian.
- **Weekend:** Lentil soup for lunch and Zapiekanka for dinner, both days; eggs on toast for breakfast.

The week at a glance

DAYS	BREAKFAST	LUNCH (PACKED)	SNACK	DINNER	DAY TOTAL
Mon, Tue	**Egg muffins** **HIM** 2 muffins + 2 slices sourdough + Greek yogurt 175 g 510 kcal, 41 g **HER** 2 muffins + 1 slice sourdough + 1 tsp butter + apple 390 kcal, 20 g	**Spicy peanut tofu bowls** **HIM** 4 parts + his chicken teriyaki 685 kcal, 39 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 boiled egg 469 kcal, 22 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Tofu stir fry** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 1/4 cup brown rice 608 kcal, 31 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 cup brown rice 470 kcal, 24 g	**HIM 2175 kcal**, 133 g **HER 1701 kcal**, 88 g
Wed	**Egg muffins** **HIM** 2 muffins + 2 slices sourdough + Greek yogurt 175 g 510 kcal, 41 g **HER** 2 muffins + 1 slice sourdough + 1 tsp butter + apple 390 kcal, 20 g	**Spicy peanut tofu bowls** **HIM** 4 parts + his chicken teriyaki 685 kcal, 39 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 boiled egg 469 kcal, 22 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Teriyaki tofu bowls** **HIM** 4 parts + his chicken teriyaki + 1/2 cup brown rice 608 kcal, 36 g **HER** 3 parts + 3/4 cup brown rice + 1 boiled egg 492 kcal, 22 g	**HIM 2174 kcal**, 137 g **HER 1724 kcal**, 86 g
Thu, Fri	**Egg muffins** **HIM** 2 muffins + 2 slices sourdough + Greek yogurt 175 g 510 kcal, 41 g **HER** 2 muffins + 1 slice sourdough + 1 tsp butter + apple 390 kcal, 20 g	**Teriyaki tofu bowls** **HIM** 4 parts + his chicken teriyaki + 1/2 cup brown rice 608 kcal, 36 g **HER** 3 parts + 3/4 cup brown rice + 1 boiled egg 492 kcal, 22 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Vegetarian bibimbap** **HIM** 4 parts 592 kcal, 29 g **HER** 3 parts 444 kcal, 21 g	**HIM 2082 kcal**, 126 g **HER 1698 kcal**, 85 g
Sat	**Eggs on toast** **HIM** 2 eggs, 2 slices sourdough, 1 tsp butter, Greek yogurt 175 g 561 kcal, 37 g **HER** 2 eggs, 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple 406 kcal, 16 g	**Lentil soup** **HIM** 4 parts + the last of his chicken teriyaki + 1 slice sourdough 584 kcal, 36 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 slice sourdough + cheddar 30 g 507 kcal, 26 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Zapiekanka** **HIM** 4 parts + Greek yogurt 175 g 621 kcal, 38 g **HER** 3 parts + Greek yogurt 175 g 498 kcal, 33 g	**HIM 2138 kcal**, 132 g **HER 1783 kcal**, 97 g
Sun	**Eggs on toast** **HIM** 2 eggs, 2 slices sourdough, 1 tsp butter, Greek yogurt 175 g 561 kcal, 37 g **HER** 2 eggs, 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple 406 kcal, 16 g	**Lentil soup** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 slice sourdough 475 kcal, 25 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 slice sourdough + cheddar 30 g 507 kcal, 26 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Zapiekanka** **HIM** 4 parts + Greek yogurt 175 g 621 kcal, 38 g **HER** 3 parts + Greek yogurt 175 g 498 kcal, 33 g	**HIM 2029 kcal**, 121 g **HER 1783 kcal**, 97 g

"4 parts" and "3 parts" are the his and hers shares of a cooked dish. Numbers are kcal and grams of protein.

The rhythm

Sunday, about 2 hours

1. Start with spicy peanut tofu bowls (about 40 min). Make the recipe once (6 servings).
2. Then egg muffins (about 40 min). Make 2 x the recipe (24 muffins).
3. Then chicken teriyaki, his meat for the week (about 20 min). Make the recipe once (4 servings).
4. Then granola bars (25 min of work plus 2 hours chilling). Make 1 1/2 x the recipe (15 bars).
5. Cook brown rice for the lunch boxes: 2 1/2 cups cooked (160 g dry).
6. Hard-boil 6 eggs.
7. Box the lunches for Monday to Wednesday. Teriyaki tofu bowls is cooked fresh on Wednesday evening.

The rest of the week

Monday Cook tofu stir fry (about 25 min). Dinner tonight and tomorrow.

Tuesday No cooking. Leftovers from Monday.

Wednesday Cook teriyaki tofu bowls (about 30 min). Eat it for dinner, with his meat on his plate, and box Thursday's and Friday's lunches.

Thursday Cook vegetarian bibimbap (about 50 min). Dinner tonight and tomorrow.

Friday No cooking.

Saturday Midday: make lentil soup (about 55 min) for today's and tomorrow's lunch. Evening: cook Zapiekanka (about 30 min) for tonight's and tomorrow's dinner. Breakfast both days is eggs on toast.

Sunday Leftovers from Saturday for lunch and dinner. Afternoon: prep the next option.

Groceries used: $217.86 for both of you for the seven days ($108.93 each). Buying every pack new costs about $347.47 at the till; most of the difference stays in the pantry for later options.

Shopping list: Winter option 4

For both of you, Monday to Sunday. Save-On-Foods prices seen Nov 10, 2026. Check the fridge and pantry first: oats, rice, soy sauce, honey, peanut butter and oil last for several options.

From H Mart (3147 Douglas St), not priced

Cooking sake (or any dry sake); Gochujang (Korean chili paste). Tofu, ginger, green onions and mushrooms are usually cheaper there too.

Pantry check (not on the list below)

Salt, pepper, neutral cooking oil, sugar or brown sugar, flour, cornstarch, vinegar, plus: cornstarch, chili paste (sambal oelek), cornstarch or potato starch, sesame seeds, dried basil, oregano, vanilla, cinnamon, sunflower seeds, coconut flakes, red pepper flakes, cumin, coriander, paprika, bay leaves, ketchup.

ITEM	NEED	BUY	PACK PRICE	COST OF AMOUNT USED
Produce				
☐ Ambrosia apple	7	7 x each, about 207 g	$0.91	$6.37
☐ Baby spinach (Western Family)	343 g	3 x 142 g	$4.99	$12.05
☐ Bean sprouts	120 g	1 x 227 g	$2.99	$1.58
☐ Broccoli	700 g	loose, by weight	$1.10/100 g	$7.70
☐ Carrots	330 g	1 x 5 lb bag	$7.99	$1.16
☐ Celery	150 g	1 x bunch, about 675 g	$5.49	$1.22
☐ Fresh ginger	40 g	loose, by weight	$0.66/100 g	$0.26
☐ Garlic	1.3 bulb	1 x 3 bulbs	$1.29	$0.56
☐ Grape tomatoes	220 g	1 x 284 g	$3.99	$3.09
☐ Green bell pepper	1	1 x each	$2.11	$2.11
☐ Green kale	1 bunch	1 x bunch	$4.49	$4.49
☐ Green onions	2.3 bunch	3 x bunch	$2.49	$5.73
☐ Lemon	1	1 x each	$0.99	$0.99
☐ Red bell pepper	3	3 x each	$2.98	$8.94
☐ White mushrooms, loose	415 g	loose, by weight	$1.32/100 g	$5.48
☐ Yellow onions	230 g	1 x 3 lb bag	$4.99	$0.84
Meat & deli				
☐ Chicken thighs, boneless skinless, value pack	567 g	1 x about 1.06 kg	$24.51	$13.11
Dairy & eggs				
☐ Cottage cheese 2% (Dairyland)	1.75 kg	3 x 750 g	$8.25	$19.25
☐ Extra firm tofu (Sunrise)	7.98 block	8 x 350 g	$3.99	$31.84
☐ Feta (Tre Stelle)	76 g	1 x 375 g	$8.99	$1.82
☐ Greek yogurt, plain 2% (Olympic)	1.93 kg	2 x 1.75 kg	$12.29	$13.52
☐ Large white eggs	38	3 x 18	$7.45	$15.73
☐ Medium cheddar block (Western Family)	210 g	1 x 600 g	$8.49	$2.97
☐ Salted butter (Western Family)	45 g	1 x 454 g	$6.69	$0.66
Grains & bakery				
☐ Classic baguette (Bake Shop)	1	1 x 350 g	$3.49	$3.49
☐ Green lentils, bulk bin	400 g	loose, by weight	$0.89/100 g	$3.56
☐ Large flake oats (Rogers)	270 g	1 x 1 kg	$5.00	$1.35
☐ Long grain brown rice (Western Family)	816 g	1 x 907 g	$3.99	$3.59
☐ Quinoa, bulk bin	115 g	loose, by weight	$1.49/100 g	$1.71
☐ Sourdough bread, sliced (Bake Shop)	25 slice	3 x 567 g, about 12 slices	$3.99	$8.31
Pantry & cans				
☐ Diced tomatoes in juice (Western Family)	400 mL	1 x 796 mL can	$2.39	$1.20
☐ Extra virgin olive oil (Western Family)	75 mL	1 x 1 L	$15.99	$1.20
☐ Liquid honey (Western Family)	402 g	1 x 1 kg	$14.79	$5.95
☐ Mini semi-sweet chocolate chips (Chipits)	90 g	1 x 270 g	$6.79	$2.26
☐ Mirin (Kikkoman Kotteri)	120 mL	1 x 296 mL	$6.99	$2.83
☐ Natural smooth peanut butter (Western Family)	258 g	1 x 1 kg	$5.99	$1.54
☐ Natural whole almonds, bulk bin	202 g	loose, by weight	$1.99/100 g	$4.03
☐ Pure sesame oil (Kosa)	85 mL	1 x 185 mL	$3.99	$1.83
☐ Rice vinegar (Marukan)	45 mL	1 x 355 mL	$5.79	$0.73
☐ Soy sauce, less sodium (Western Family)	365 mL	1 x 450 mL	$3.49	$2.83
☐ Vegetable broth, low sodium (Western Family)	1.5 L	2 x 946 mL	$2.49	$3.95
Allowance for spices, oil, vinegar and the H Mart items below (my estimate, not priced)				**$6.00**
Groceries used for this option, both of you				**$217.86**
At the till if every pack is bought new (the remainder carries into later weeks)				**$347.47**

Cook and split: Winter option 4

In cooking order. The outline is a reminder in my words; follow the linked recipe for amounts of seasoning and exact steps.

Spicy peanut tofu bowls SUNDAY

For Mon, Tue and Wed lunches · Make the recipe once (6 servings) · about 40 min · full recipe: pinchofyum.com/spicy-peanut-tofu-bowls (Pinch of Yum)

BUY FOR IT	2.3 block extra firm tofu; 30 mL extra virgin olive oil; 700 g broccoli; 2 red bell pepper; 280 g long grain brown rice; 130 g natural smooth peanut butter; 80 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 30 mL pure sesame oil; 30 mL rice vinegar; 42 g liquid honey; 10 g fresh ginger; 0.1 bulb garlic. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Press and cube the tofu, toss with cornstarch, and roast it on a sheet pan with the broccoli and pepper strips. 2. Cook the rice. 3. Blend peanut butter, soy, sesame oil, vinegar, chili paste, sweetener, ginger, garlic and water into a sauce. 4. Bowl up rice, tofu and vegetables; drizzle with sauce.
SPLIT	Set 1 serving aside first for the freezer or the weekend. Divide the rest into 3 his-and-hers pairs (Mon, Tue and Wed lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 0.95 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.71.
SIDES	Him: nothing extra. Her: 1 boiled egg.
KEEP	The author says the leftovers suit meal prep and that it freezes. Fridge life of 4 days is my guidance.
REHEAT	Microwave 90 s; add the peanut sauce after.
ALLERGENS	Soy, wheat (soy sauce), peanuts, sesame
NOTE	Costed with brown rice in place of white.

Chicken teriyaki SUNDAY

For his five lunches and Wednesday's dinner · Make the recipe once (4 servings) · about 20 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/teriyaki-chicken (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	567 g chicken thighs, boneless skinless, value pack; 75 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 63 g liquid honey; 15 mL rice vinegar; 0.3 bulb garlic; 15 g fresh ginger; 0.4 bunch green onions. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Toss chicken pieces with soy, salt, pepper and a little cornstarch. 2. Whisk water, honey, vinegar, garlic, ginger and the rest of the soy and cornstarch. 3. Sear the chicken, pour in the sauce and simmer until glossy.
SPLIT	For him only. Portion into 6: a 0.6 serving portion (about 90 g cooked chicken) each, one for every lunch box and one for Wednesday's dinner. The remaining 0.4 servings goes on his weekend lunch. Keep Monday to Wednesday's in the fridge and freeze the rest.
SIDES	Goes on top of his portion of whatever the lunch is. Hers stays vegetarian.
KEEP	The page gives no storage time. My guidance: 3 days in the fridge.
REHEAT	Microwave 60 to 90 s.
ALLERGENS	Soy, wheat
NOTE	Cooked only for him. The nutrition figure is for the chicken alone.

Egg muffins SUNDAY

For breakfasts, Mon to Fri · Make 2 x the recipe (24 muffins) · about 40 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/healthy-breakfast-egg-muffins (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	60 g baby spinach; 1 red bell pepper; 1 green bell pepper; 220 g grape tomatoes; 20 large white eggs; 76 g feta. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Divide spinach, peppers and tomatoes among greased muffin cups. 2. Whisk eggs, whites and seasoning; pour over and top with feta. 3. Bake at 350 F about 25 min.
SPLIT	Each weekday: 2 muffins for him, 2 muffins for her. 4 left over for the weekend or the freezer.
SIDES	Him: 2 slices sourdough, Greek yogurt 175 g. Her: 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple.
KEEP	3 days in the fridge, 3 months in the freezer (author). Freeze Thursday's and Friday's.
REHEAT	Microwave 30 to 45 s from the fridge, about 60 s from frozen.
ALLERGENS	Eggs, milk (feta)
NOTE	The tomatoes are baked in. To keep his completely tomato-free, leave them out of half the cups.

Granola bars SUNDAY

For snacks, Mon to Fri · Make 1 1/2 x the recipe (15 bars) · about 135 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/healthy-granola-bars (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	270 g large flake oats; 202 g natural whole almonds, bulk bin; 255 g liquid honey; 128 g natural smooth peanut butter; 90 g mini semi-sweet chocolate chips. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Toast oats, nuts and seeds. 2. Warm honey with peanut butter, stir in vanilla, cinnamon and the toasted mix; fold in chips. 3. Press firmly into a lined pan, chill 2 hours, cut into 10.
SPLIT	Every day including the weekend: 1 bar for him, 1 bar for her. 1 left over for the weekend or the freezer.
SIDES	Him: cottage cheese 125 g. Her: cottage cheese 125 g.
KEEP	1 week at room temperature, 2 weeks in the fridge, 2 months frozen (author).
REHEAT	Eat as is.
ALLERGENS	Peanuts, tree nuts; chocolate chips usually contain milk and soy

Tofu stir fry MONDAY EVENING

For Mon and Tue dinners · Make the recipe once (4 servings) · about 25 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/tofu-stir-fry (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	2.27 block extra firm tofu; 45 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 0.3 bulb garlic; 1 bunch green onions; 15 g fresh ginger; 283 g baby spinach; 10 mL pure sesame oil. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Dry and cube the tofu; fry it in hot oil until golden, seasoning with soy. 2. Add garlic, scallions, ginger and chili paste. 3. Wilt in the spinach by the handful; finish with sesame seeds and sesame oil.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Mon and Tue dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: 1 1/4 cup brown rice. Her: 1 cup brown rice.
KEEP	Up to 5 days in the fridge (author).
REHEAT	Microwave gently, 60 to 90 s (author).
ALLERGENS	Soy, wheat (soy sauce), sesame
NOTE	Meatless.

Teriyaki tofu bowls WEDNESDAY EVENING

For Wed dinner, Thu and Fri lunches · Make 2 x the recipe (4 servings) · about 30 min · full recipe: justonecookbook.com/teriyaki-tofu-bowl (Just One Cookbook)

BUY FOR IT	2.26 block extra firm tofu; 120 mL mirin; 120 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 0.4 bunch green onions. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Drain and press the tofu, slice it and dust with starch. 2. Whisk sake, mirin, soy and sugar for the teriyaki sauce. 3. Pan-fry the tofu until golden on both sides, pour in the sauce and reduce until glossy. 4. Serve over rice with scallions and sesame seeds.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 3 his-and-hers pairs (Wed dinner, Thu and Fri lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 0.76 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.57.
SIDES	Him: 1/2 cup brown rice. Her: 3/4 cup brown rice, 1 boiled egg.
KEEP	3 days in an airtight container; the author advises against freezing tofu.
REHEAT	Microwave 60 to 90 s with the rice.
ALLERGENS	Soy, wheat (soy sauce), sesame
H MART	Cooking sake (or any dry sake)
NOTE	The recipe serves 2, so this plan doubles it. Its nutrition figure does not appear to include the rice, so rice is counted as a side. Sake is not costed.

Vegetarian bibimbap THURSDAY EVENING

For Thu and Fri dinners · Make the recipe once (4 servings) · about 50 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/vegetarian-bibimbap (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	1.15 block extra firm tofu; 45 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 42 g liquid honey; 45 mL pure sesame oil; 1 bunch green kale; 120 g bean sprouts; 0.4 bulb garlic; 15 mL extra virgin olive oil; 0.5 bunch green onions; 115 g white mushrooms, loose; 180 g carrots; 4 large white eggs; 115 g quinoa, bulk bin. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Crisp the tofu. 2. Blanch the kale and bean sprouts separately and dress each with soy and sesame oil. 3. Saute the mushrooms, then the carrot matchsticks. 4. Fry the eggs. Build bowls over quinoa and top with the gochujang sauce.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Thu and Fri dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: nothing extra. Her: nothing extra.
KEEP	Vegetables and tofu keep up to 2 days (author), which is why this is a Monday and Tuesday dinner.
REHEAT	Rewarm the vegetables and tofu in a pan; fry the eggs fresh.
ALLERGENS	Soy, wheat (soy sauce), sesame, eggs
H MART	Gochujang (Korean chili paste)
NOTE	Meatless. Costed with white mushrooms in place of shiitake.

Lentil soup SATURDAY MIDDAY

For Saturday and Sunday lunches · Make the recipe once (6 servings) · about 55 min · full recipe: recipetineats.com/lentil-soup (RecipeTin Eats)

BUY FOR IT	30 mL extra virgin olive oil; 150 g yellow onions; 0.2 bulb garlic; 150 g carrots; 150 g celery; 400 g green lentils, bulk bin; 400 mL diced tomatoes in juice; 1.5 L vegetable broth, low sodium; 1 lemon. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Soften onion and garlic, then carrot and celery, slowly. 2. Add lentils, tomato, broth and spices; simmer about 35 min. 3. Blitz a little of it to thicken, finish with lemon.
SPLIT	Set 2 servings aside first for the freezer or the weekend. Divide the rest into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Saturday and Sunday lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: 1 slice sourdough. Her: 1 slice sourdough, cheddar 30 g.
KEEP	5 days in the fridge, 3 months in the freezer (author).
REHEAT	Microwave 2 to 3 min with a splash of water.
ALLERGENS	None of the major allergens (check the broth label)
NOTE	Meatless (made with vegetable broth) and the cheapest pot in the plan.

Zapiekanka SATURDAY EVENING

For Saturday and Sunday dinners · Make the recipe once (2 servings) · about 30 min · full recipe: polonist.com/polish-zapiekanka (Polonist)

BUY FOR IT	1 classic baguette; 300 g white mushrooms, loose; 80 g yellow onions; 150 g medium cheddar block. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Halve the baguette lengthwise and scoop out a little crumb. 2. Saute chopped mushrooms and onion 7 to 10 min; season. 3. Fill the bread, cover with grated cheese and bake until golden. 4. Finish with ketchup.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Saturday and Sunday dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 0.57 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.43.
SIDES	Him: Greek yogurt 175 g. Her: Greek yogurt 175 g.
KEEP	The page gives no storage time. My guidance: cook the mushroom filling once, keep it 2 days, and bake the second night's halves fresh.
REHEAT	Bake 8 to 10 min at 400 F rather than microwaving.
ALLERGENS	Wheat, milk
NOTE	Polish street food. Costed with medium cheddar; the recipe suggests a mild cheese such as gouda.